



A FIRE last month has signaled the anticlimactic end for the historic Morrison Hotel on South Hope Street in downtown Los Angeles.

WILL HOTEL RISE FROM ASHES?

The Morrison was made famous by the Doors, then suffered years of neglect. Just as it was set for a new lease on life, a fire tore through the building.

By Nathan Solis

Music photographer Henry Diltz first laid eyes on the Morrison Hotel lobby 55 years ago. He and his business partner Gary Burden drove to the hotel on Hope Street in downtown Los Angeles with Doors keyboardist Ray Manzarek and lead singer Jim Morrison in their VW band van in December 1969. The Doors approached Diltz and Burden to put together a cover for an unnamed album. An improvised photo shoot of the legendary band inside the lobby would eventually become the cover to one of the Doors' biggest-selling albums. The visit to the four-story building marked the inception of the aging building into rock 'n' roll history. Over the following five decades,



HENRY DILTZ, photographer of the famous "Morrison Hotel" album cover, attends the Day of the Doors pop-up event in 2020.

the hotel has been the subject of lawsuits, tenant complaints and unfulfilled plans for multimillion-dollar renovations, culminating last month with a major fire on the day after Christmas that ripped through the 111-year-old building. Although preservationists are pressing the city to save the brick building, the future remains uncertain and the end seems near. "The whole world suddenly is interested in preservation when it's something they feel emotionally attached to," preservationist Kim Cooper said. "They don't feel emotionally attached to 111 affordable units in a neighborhood they've never been to that's been boarded up for 20 years, but they know the Morrison Hotel. It's got this kind of ruby dust of celebrity cachet." [See Morrison, A10]

Inside the U.S. effort to break up Google

Search and digital ad giant faces increasing scrutiny amid calls to open its technology to rivals and share data.

By Queenie Wong and Wendy Lee

SAN FRANCISCO — In its early days, the quirky tech startup known as Google adopted a visionary corporate credo: "Don't be evil." That later evolved into the motto: "Do the right thing," reflecting the idealistic ambitions of the company's founders that its technology could be a force for good. Google's pioneering search technology would transform the internet and its home in Silicon Valley. But more than two decades later, Google is confronting a starkly different view of its values and conduct, one that has been shaped by federal prosecutors who've depicted the tech giant as an "industry behemoth" that has "corrupted legitimate competition." "Google is a monopolist, and it has acted as one to maintain its monopoly," said Amit P. Mehta, a judge of the U.S. District Court for the District of Columbia, in a landmark ruling in August that could reshape the future of search. The decision represented a big legal blow for one of California's most successful technology brands, challenging its influence over how people find and consume information online. Now the Mountain View-based company is at a pivotal point in its nearly 30-



HOUSING under construction for adults with developmental disabilities in Portola Valley. The project relied on state laws that limited the city's ability to stop it.

Wealthy town nears bankruptcy in dispute over affordable homes

On a Sunday afternoon a few years ago, about a dozen neighbors held a meeting with Craig Hughes, who was then the mayor of Portola Valley. The backyard gathering in the small, wealthy Silicon Valley enclave was civil, Hughes said, but his constituents left an unmistakable message. If Hughes and other town leaders produced a state-mandated affordable housing plan that

You can't fight City Hall, the adage goes, but here, residents are the Goliath

By Liam Dillon
Reporting from Portola Valley, Calif.

wasn't to the residents' liking, they should expect a battery of litigation that could lead to Portola Valley's bankruptcy. In a sign of their seriousness, one couple already had hired an attorney well-versed in California politics, the former mayor of San José. "It was a warning," Hughes recalled. Now, after years of housing [See Portola Valley, A7]

Lawmakers and police bracing for Trump's Jan. 6 riot pardons

By Kevin Freking

WASHINGTON — The fourth anniversary of the Jan. 6 attack on the Capitol has a new focus as lawmakers brace for the prospect that President-elect Donald Trump may soon pardon many of the more than 1,500

people charged with crimes for their actions related to the riot. Trump said he would issue pardons to rioters on "Day 1" of his presidency, which begins Jan. 20. "Most likely, I'll do it very quickly," he said recently on NBC's "Meet the Press." He added that "those people have suf-

fered long and hard. And there may be some exceptions to it. I have to look. But, you know, if somebody was radical, crazy." His promise, made throughout his campaign for the White House, is shadowing events Monday as lawmakers gather to certify [See Pardons, A10]

Is your vehicle spying on you?
The latest cars know where you've been and where you're going. They also have access to your data. **NATION, A5**

New monuments honor tribal land
Sites in the desert near Joshua Tree and amid forests and lakes near Oregon are on Biden's list. **CALIFORNIA, B1**

Weather
Mostly sunny. L.A. Basin: 71/50. **B5**
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